made, it became established fact. Meat-eating has been reported in just about every area where chimps have been studied, from Gombe and Mahale Mountains National Park, Tanzania, to Tai National Park, in Côte d'Ivoire.

Such behavior has implications for human evolution. Science has long questioned why and when humans first began eating meat. From prehistoric stone tools and marks on bones, paleontologists know that the early hominids were using stone tools to cut meat from animals bones 2.5 million years ago, but it is not known what they were eating between then and 7 million years ago, when the common ancestor of chimpanzees and humans is thought to have lived.

It is likely that these early hominids hunted prey. Although they did not have large canine teeth like chimpanzees, these are not necessary for hunting and killing small prey. Biologists have observed that chimps hunting colobus monkeys grab them from the trees and then kill them by repeatedly thumping the bodies on the ground; early hominids could have hunted and killed in a similar fashion long before the earliest known tools.